

Jake Cox

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EDUCATION

DePaul University

Bachelor of Arts, Journalism, cum laude

- Minor: English Literature; Certificate: Geographic Information Systems

Graduated June 2026

Chicago

WORK EXPERIENCE

Michigan Public (via The Magpie Project)

Product Manager

June 2026 – Present

Remote

- Manage product development for a daily word game built on a public radio archive, from user testing through public launch
- Run user testing and focus groups, turning raw feedback into ranked priorities engineers and editors can act on
- Translate scattered input from Slack, meetings and docs into clear requirements, user stories and launch checklists
- Write SOPs and internal documentation that onboard new contributors without hand-holding
- Scope analytics and data-access work across streaming, donor and web platforms for a station-wide BI buildout
- Coordinate across editorial, audience and external development teams to keep a launch date on schedule

Block Club Chicago

Newsletter Intern

April 2025 – June 2026

Chicago

- Launched and scaled a [WhatsApp broadcast channel](#) to 3,200+ subscribers in six weeks, delivering verified immigration coverage to communities most affected by federal enforcement and earning recognition from Knight Foundation, AJP, Medill and Reuters
- Produce and publish daily newsletters to 130,000+ subscribers, making real-time story selection and placement calls against deadline
- Analyze open rates, CTR and CTOR across daily sends to A/B test subject lines and optimize story hierarchy for engagement lift
- Report breaking news and enterprise features across civic, arts, LGBTQ+ and weather beats for a nonprofit hyperlocal newsroom
- Partner with editors and reporters to shape newsletter editions around shifting coverage priorities throughout the news cycle

DePaul CJIE / NBC 5 Chicago

Producer & Lead Data Analyst

March 2025 – November 2025

Chicago

- Led data analysis, fact-checking and structural editing on two long-form investigations produced with NBC 5 Chicago's I-Team
- Built a Python web scraper to extract Illinois GA witness slips, surfacing opposition patterns that powered an investigative report
- Developed an [interactive news app](#) visualizing how Illinois' per-wager sports betting tax hits bettors
- Both reports won Peter Lisagor Awards given by the Chicago Headline Club

AWARDS, SKILLS & MEMBERSHIPS

- **Awards:** Peter Lisagor Awards, Best Deadline Reporting, Best Education Reporting (Student) and Best Politics/Government and Sports Reporting (Student) (Chicago Headline Club); 4th place Best News Story, 6th place Best of Show News Website, plus Honorable Mentions for Breaking News, In-Depth News and Social Media Reporting (Associated Collegiate Press)
- **Audience & Publishing:** Google Analytics, Google Trends, Chartbeat, SEO, newsletter metrics (open rate, CTR, CTOR), WordPress, Newspack, Buffer, WhatsApp channels, email marketing, AP Style, Meta Business Suite, Active Campaign (ESP), Notion
- **Data & Visual:** Python, R, HTML, ArcGIS Pro, Leaflet.js, Datawrapper, Adobe Creative Cloud, Canva, CapCut
- **Professional Affiliations:** Online News Association (ONA), Investigative Reporters & Editors (IRE), Chicago Headline Club

CLIPS

[The Windy City Times Told LGBTQ+ Stories When No One Else Would. 40 Years Later, They're Still At It](#) — Block Club Chicago

- Long-form feature story on the legacy of Chicago's LGBTQ+ newspaper

[How to reach new audiences quickly with WhatsApp](#) — Newspack Blog

- Technical guide on how newsrooms can create a WhatsApp channel like I did at Block Club Chicago

[Opioid Task Force Takes On Chicago's Fentanyl 'Epicenter' \(Afternoon Digest\)](#) — Block Club Chicago

- Newsletter I wrote and edited for Block Club Chicago's Afternoon Digest with over 80,000 subscribers

More clips and case studies available on my portfolio: jakec04.github.io